

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Better late than never!



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about manners and customs.
- I can talk about life experiences.
- I can express possibility or certainty.

Ask your partner:

- What do you know about North American sports? Do you like them?
- What is the most popular sport in your country? Do you like it? Why or why not?





Let's Explore!

Peter gives Rosa **the lowdown*** on how baseball works.

* When you give "*the lowdown*" on something, you go through all its details.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Peter:** I hope we'll make it in time for the start of the game. I managed to get some pretty good seats. I had bought cheaper tickets at first, before you told me you liked sports. So, I thought you could enjoy our national pastime up close!
- Rosa:** I'm excited, even though I know very little about baseball. I had read up on it before I moved to Boston, but I didn't go very far in my research.
- Peter:** That's fine. I'm sure you must be familiar with home runs and innings.
- Rosa:** Not quite ... what's an inning?
- Peter:** It's like a half-time in soccer. Each team bats, then defends. Games usually last up to 9 innings.
- Rosa:** That must last longer than a game of soccer!
- Peter:** It often does. Some games may be delayed or postponed because of that. I remember one time, people had left right before our best player hit it out of the park.
- Rosa:** Oh, I've heard that expression before!
- Peter:** For sure. We use many baseball metaphors in English.
- Rosa:** Before I came to the States, I had only heard about how popular baseball was in Boston. Now I understand.
- Peter:** Of course! You must have heard we all support the Red Sox here!
- Rosa:** Well, baseball is still incomprehensible to me, but I might make an effort for you.
- Peter:** Better late than never. You couldn't possibly regret it!
- Rosa:** Shall we order dessert?
- Peter:** Sorry, Rosa, but we are really late now. We'll have to take a rain check on that dessert.
- Rosa:** Another baseball expression?





Let's Practice!

Peter keeps on talking about baseball!

Instructions: Fill in the gaps using the phrases from the word bank. Use capital letters where necessary. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. I'm sure _____ familiar with home runs and innings.
2. _____ longer than a game of soccer!
3. Some games _____ or postponed because of bad weather.
4. _____ heard we all support the New York Yankees here!
5. _____ an effort so that I learn a bit more.

Word bank

- I might make
- you must be
- You must have
- That must last
- may be delayed



Let's Practice!

Baseball is a great experience!

Instructions: Read the clues. Find the words in the wordsearch below.

Words

1. A division of the game during which the teams have the opportunity to score
2. To be a fan of a team
3. Impossible to understand
4. A sport in which you hit a ball with a bat
5. An expression you use when you have to postpone something





Extension Activity

Be a Sportswriter for a Day

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Imagine that you are a professional sportswriter.
- Write a recap of the last sporting event you attended.
- Start by choosing a catchy headline.
- Make some point-form notes including details of the game and your personal opinion of the events.
- Compile your notes into a complete paragraph.
- Share your story with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I take notes on a past sporting event.

☐ ☐

I compile my notes into a paragraph.

☐ ☐

I share my notes with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **better late than never** (expression): used when it's better for something to happen late than not at all
e.g. Better late than never. You couldn't possibly regret it!
- **inning** (noun): a division of a game during which the teams have the opportunity to score
e.g. I'm sure you must be familiar with home runs and innings.
- **to hit it out of the park** (expression): in baseball, to hit the ball hard enough to send it out of the field
e.g. People had left right before our best player hit it out of the park.
- **to support** (verb): to be a fan of a team
e.g. You must have heard we all support the Red Sox here!
- **incomprehensible** (adjective): impossible to understand
e.g. Well, baseball is still incomprehensible to me.
- **rain check** (expression): to refuse an offer or invitation but say that you might accept it later
e.g. We'll have to take a rain check on that dessert.



Learning Points

Simple Past vs Past Perfect

You use the Past Perfect tense to identify and talk about an 'earlier past'.

You use the Simple Past to talk about a finished action that happened at a specific time in the past.

When you are talking about a past event, you can refer to something that happened at an earlier time to that past event by using the Past Perfect tense.

The structure of the Past Perfect is:

Subject + had + past participle

*I **had read up** on it before I moved to Boston.*

Which event happened *first*? I read up on baseball.

Which event happened *later*? I moved to Boston.

You use the Past Perfect tense (not Simple Past) when you want to talk about how long something had continued **up to a past moment**.

Example:

Before I came to the States, I had only heard about how popular baseball was in Boston.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about the action that happened after that prior action in the Past Perfect tense.

Examples:

- *I had bought cheaper tickets at first, before you told me you liked sports.*
- *I had read up on it before I moved to Boston, but I didn't get very far in my research.*





Learning Points

Modals for Possibility and Certainty

You can use modals to talk about degrees of certainty.

You use them to describe what is definite, probable, possible, or impossible from the speaker's point of view.

You can use *must*, *may*, *might*, and *could* to describe degrees of certainty.

You can use modals with the Present Perfect to talk about the possibility of a past event that is not clear in the present context.

Example:

You **must have heard** we all support the Red Sox here!

Must = it's very likely

Must not / Could not / Can't = it's not possible

May / Might / Can / Could = it's possible

May not / Might not = it's possible this is not true

Modal	Meaning
You must be familiar with home runs and innings.	It's very likely you are familiar with home runs and innings.
You couldn't possibly regret it!	It's not possible to regret it.
Some games may be delayed or postponed because of that.	It's possible to delay the games.

